

From mid-morning until noon, he basked in the sun beside the pool, conducting his far-flung businesses by long-distance telephone. Lunch included a special dessert to appease his sweet tooth. Afterward he usually took a half-hour nap, then played a round of golf."

So what happened to Kennedy during this semiretired life? He became super-rich. "I really began to make money," he once told a friend at poolside, "when I came down here to sit on my butt and think." He invested primarily in real estate and oil. And he made more money than during all his work years combined.

Son-in-law Stephen Smith still manages the family fortune the way Kennedy did in his later years. Said to be one of America's shrewdest investors and asset swappers, Smith never runs businesses himself. He refuses to clutter his mind with day-to-day operations. Rather, he moves hundreds of millions of dollars based on ideas and concepts.

You don't have the Kennedys' millions. But you do have enough money to retire. When you retire, you free yourself from demanding schedules, unhappy clients, and drops in sales. Like Joseph Kennedy, you can ponder the business world at your leisure, choosing your investments carefully.

If you're like me, you'll decide to let others worry about becoming millionaires or billionaires. You'll decide that putting extra money in the bank improves your life so slightly it's not worth the bother.

On the other hand, as you ponder the current state of affairs you may come up with an idea you want to try. Buy and sell paintings and sculpture like my friend Nick. Consult part time like my friend Chambers. Invent and market a new rat poison, instant wine, or a microwave oven that doubles as a garbage incinerator. Whatever you do, you'll do it with a clear mind, unhurried by the demands of the career game. You can focus your full creative powers on ideas rather than on bureaucratic snarls.

Our world is full of people who started making really big